OLA ONE

One journey. Every mode. One Ola.

The 2035 opportunity: make the entire daily journey predictable, not just the individual ride.

600M	1,095 km	~500
people projected to live in India's urban areas by 2036 (World Bank)	metro/RRTS operational across 26 cities in 2025 (PIB)	commute journeys per user per year (assumption: 5 days × 50 weeks × 2 directions)

Why this problem matters

India is urbanising while metro, rail and bus networks expand. The opportunity is not another vehicle. It is making an increasingly multimodal commute work as one system. By 2035 we expect:

- **More modes per commute.** Metro/RRTS and city bus networks keep growing, so a typical commute crosses two to three modes (assumption).
- **Fewer but higher-stakes commute days.** Hybrid work cuts office days but makes each fixed-time commute matter more (assumption).
- **Open rails for cross-operator booking.** UPI, NCMC-style transit cards and open networks such as ONDC make one booking across operators technically feasible (assumption).
- **Cheaper electric feeder capacity.** Electric 3-wheelers and shuttles make first/last-mile supply affordable (assumption).

The commuter problem

Time uncertainty
Will I reach on time? Each leg has its own delay risk.

Transfer friction
Separate apps, tickets and payments for every leg.

Disruption
When one leg fails, the user is on their own.

Accessibility
Most journeys are not designed for seniors or mobility-sensitive users.

Who we are building for

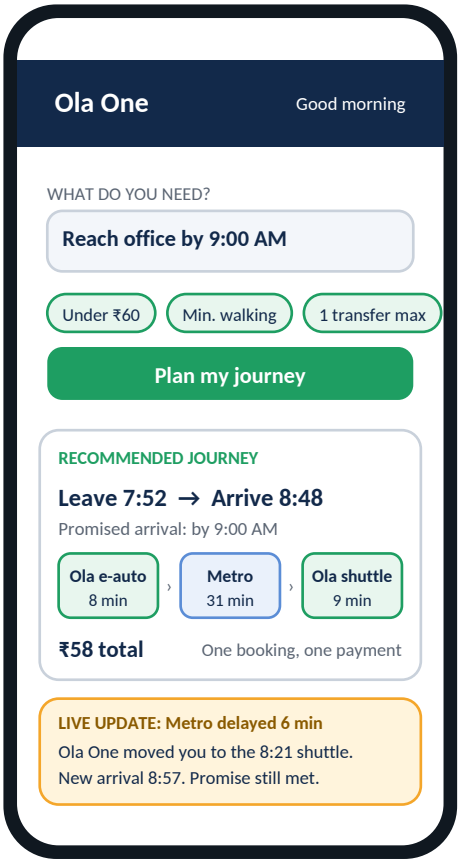
	User	Core need	Why this order
Launch user	Salaried commuter, 25–40, on a multimodal corridor in Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai or Pune	Time, affordability, reliability	Highest frequency (~500 journeys/yr), already mixes modes, reachable through employers
Expansion wedge	Senior citizens, family/caregivers, mobility-sensitive users	Safety, simplicity, visibility, accessible low-friction travel	Highest unmet need and a second buyer: the caregiver who books and tracks for a parent
Later	Students, campus and corporate shuttle riders	Predictable low-cost commute	Pooled, pass-based demand that raises utilisation

> ***"The problem isn't a lack of mobility options. It's the lack of a system that makes those options work together."***

Assumptions: urbanisation continues; multiple modes coexist by 2035; shared EV economics support high-utilisation services; users accept intelligent journey planning.

WHAT WE BUILD

Ola One is an intelligent multimodal mobility platform that plans, books and manages a user's complete journey across public transit, shared EVs and other modes, in one experience.



Illustrative app screens: outcome request, recommended journey, live replan.

Core user experience

1. **Set the outcome.** "Reach work by 9 AM, under ₹60, with minimal walking."
2. **Ola One optimises.** Weighs time, price, walking, availability, traffic, transit status and disruptions.
3. **One journey.** e.g. Ola e-auto → Metro → Ola shuttle → destination.
4. **One execution layer.** Coordinated bookings, one payment, one live status.
5. **Continuous management.** If a disruption threatens the promise, Ola One replans within the user's constraints.

Journey, step by step

User	Ola One
Sets the outcome	"Get me there by 9 AM."
Sets constraints	Budget, walking tolerance, preferred modes
Something changes	Detects the disruption and replans
Arrives	Within the promised arrival window

Ola-operated supply (the "Ola feeder"). Public transit is the backbone. Ola adds **electric 3-wheeler feeders** (door to station) and **8–12-seat electric shuttles** on fixed micro-routes (station to tech park or campus) only where the network has gaps. No two-wheelers.

TODAY: MULTI-APP, SINGLE-LEG BOOKING

Cab app 1. select and book › **Metro app** 2. check map, buy ticket › **Auto app** 3. book last mile

3 apps, 3 payments
no arrival promise

OLA ONE: OUTCOME-BASED ORCHESTRATION

You set the outcome "By 9 AM, under ₹60" › **Ola One optimises** time, price, walking, delays › **e-auto** **Metro** **shuttle**

1 app, 1 payment
1 promised arrival

The differentiator: resolve, don't just recommend

If a metro delay threatens the promised arrival, Ola One does not just notify the user. It re-plans the next leg within the user's constraints and presents a new commitment. AI is the intelligence layer: **predict** demand and delays → **personalise** to preferences → **optimise** the journey → **adapt** when conditions change.

Personalisation example. A senior citizen prioritises minimal walking, fewer transfers and accessibility over the cheapest route. A commuter prioritises time and price. A caregiver sees the live journey and gets alerts when a parent boards, transfers or arrives.

WHY THIS SOLUTION?

The core product choice: **orchestration over ownership**. The problem is fragmentation, not a shortage of vehicles. We considered owning more transport, adding another mode, or simply helping users navigate existing modes.

Approach	What it solves	Trade-off	Decision
Own mass transit	High-capacity commuting	Capital, infrastructure and regulatory intensity; fixed routes	Not the starting point
Shared EV network	Affordable shared mobility	Does not connect the whole multimodal journey; utilisation risk	Supply layer inside Ola One
Navigation only	Route discovery	Recommends but does not execute or own the journey outcome	Insufficient
Ola One	End-to-end journey orchestration	Integration and operational complexity	**Chosen**

Trade-offs behind the choice

- **Ownership vs orchestration.** Integrate public transit; add Ola-operated EV supply where the network has gaps.
- **Automation vs control.** The user sets priorities; Ola optimises within those constraints.
- **Choice vs simplicity.** Show one recommended journey first; expose alternatives only when useful.
- **Reliability vs ecosystem dependence.** Accept integration complexity because the value comes from coordinating modes, not replacing them.

Who else is in this space, and where Ola One wins

Player	What they do well	Gap Ola One exploits
Google Maps	Cross-mode route discovery at massive scale	No booking, no payment, no commitment, no supply of its own
Uber, Rapido, Namma Yatri (on ONDC)	On-demand single-leg rides	Optimise one ride, not the door-to-door journey or a promised arrival
Chalo, metro and city transit apps	Ticketing and live tracking for one operator	Single-operator; no cross-mode coordination or replanning
Ola One	Outcome promise, live replanning, one payment	Backed by owned feeder supply so the promise can actually be kept

Honest risk: Google or Uber could add journey bundling. Our defence is not the routing layer. It is the combination of owned feeder supply, transit integrations and an arrival promise that only works when all three exist.

How Ola One makes money

Revenue line	How it works
Ola feeder fares	Pay-per-ride on Ola-operated 3-wheeler and shuttle legs (roughly ₹10–20 per leg)
Service fee	About ₹5 per journey for planning, booking, payment and the arrival promise
Ola One Pass	Monthly subscription (assumed ₹599) for capped feeder rides and late-arrival credits
Corporate plans	Employer-paid commute for campuses and tech parks

Illustrative unit economics (₹58 journey): Metro ₹28 (pass-through) + Ola feeder legs ₹25 + service fee ₹5. At target utilisation, feeder margin of about 35% (~₹9) plus the fee, less payment costs, gives a contribution of about **₹12–15 per journey**. At ~500 journeys a year, that is roughly ₹6,000–7,500 per active user per year. All figures are assumptions to validate in a pilot corridor.

> **The strategic choice: we don't need to own every vehicle. We need to own the journey.**

Ola One uses existing transport capacity where it works and adds Ola-operated shared EV capacity where first/last-mile or corridor gaps remain.

WHY OLA + THE PATH TO 100M

Ola One needs physical EV capability, mobility software and the ability to run a distributed network. Ola Electric already has important building blocks; the 2035 product adds the missing orchestration layer.

EV + energy
Ola Electric describes capabilities across software, electronics, motor/drivetrain, cell & battery and manufacturing. Hypothesis: an in-house stack can lower cost per km of feeder vehicles.

Software + AI
Ola describes MoveOS and an AI platform; MoveOS includes navigation, live location and connected-vehicle capabilities, useful for fleet telematics and replanning.

Distribution
Ola describes an installed base of 1M+ vehicle deliveries and an integrated sales, service and charging ecosystem.

What Ola still needs to build: transit partnerships; multimodal data and integration; shared-mobility operations (a new muscle); accessibility infrastructure; end-to-end trust and reliability systems. **Assumption:** ride-hailing demand data and brand access through the wider Ola group, since Ola Consumer is a separate entity from Ola Electric.

100M is a scale hypothesis, not a forecast

Funnel step	Users	Assumption
Urban residents, 2036	~600M	World Bank projection
Regular commuters (work or school)	~270M	45% of urban residents
In cities with metro, BRT or organised bus corridors	~200M	75% of regular commuters, 2035 coverage
Ola One regular users	**100M**	**~50% of addressable commuters**

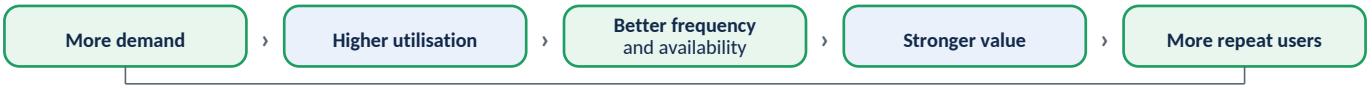
City tier	Cities	Regular users / city	Total
Megacities (Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, etc.)	6	~7M	~42M
Large cities (Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Lucknow, etc.)	14	~2.5M	~35M
Mid-size metro and transit cities	20	~1.15M	~23M
Total	**40**	**2.5M average**	**~100M**

Sanity check: 50% penetration of addressable commuters is a stretch. It works only if Ola One becomes the default commute layer, the way UPI became the default payment layer. If it reaches only half of that, 40–50M regular users still makes it one of India's largest mobility products. Mass adoption needs dense city-by-city expansion, not one launch.

How it scales

Stage	Move	Gate to next stage
1. Win dense corridors	Prove reliability and repeat use where several modes coexist	On-time arrival ≥95%; 90-day retention ≥55%
2. Expand across major cities	More corridors, more transit integrations, more feeder supply	Positive contribution per journey in mature corridors
3. Broaden use cases	Students, campuses, seniors, families, everyday urban journeys	Caregiver and campus plans at scale
4. Reach mass-market	Extend to 40 cities; become the regular mobility layer	Habit: 6+ commutes per active user per week

Growth flywheel. More journeys also improve demand prediction and vehicle positioning, which lifts reliability.



HOW WILL WE KNOW IT'S WORKING?

The product promise is simple: get people where they need to be, when they need to be there.

> **North Star Metric: Successful Commutes. Completed Ola One journeys delivered within the user's promised arrival window.**

Area	Metric	Target (mature corridor)
User value	Weekly active commuters; commutes per active user per week; 30/90-day retention	6+ commutes per week; 70% / 55% retention
Reliability	On-time arrival rate; journey failure rate; disruption recovery rate	≥95% on time; <1% failures; ≥80% of disruptions recovered inside the promise
Network	Feeder vehicle utilisation; high-demand corridor coverage; average transfer time	≥60% peak utilisation; ≤6 min transfer
Economics	Contribution margin per journey; CAC; LTV/CAC	₹12+ per journey by month 18 in a corridor; LTV/CAC ≥3
Guardrails	Cost per journey; safety incidents per million journeys; replan rate; caregiver and senior satisfaction	Safety incidents trending down; replan rate <15% (higher means the promise is set too tight)

What must be true for 100M

Reliable Users trust the promised arrival window.	**Affordable** Compelling value versus realistic alternatives.	**Available** Enough supply and transit integrations in each city.
Seamless Transfer complexity stays behind the interface.	**Trusted** Safety, accessibility and caregiver visibility widen adoption.	**Habit-forming** Ola One becomes part of regular mobility.

Key risks and how we manage them

Risk	Mitigation
Transit data and API access	Start with open data and MoUs with metro corporations; use open networks (ONDC) where available
Dependence on partners	Ola-operated fallback supply on every launch corridor
Promise reliability	Conservative arrival windows with buffer; late-arrival credits; replan before failure
Feeder utilisation and economics	Deploy only where demand density is proven; pooled routes; pass-based demand
Incumbents bundling modes	Win on owned supply plus the arrival guarantee, not routing alone

Key assumptions

2035: urbanisation and multimodal transport continue to grow; shared EV economics support high-utilisation services; users accept intelligent journey planning. **Product:** Ola can secure transit partnerships, operate shared EV capacity economically and deliver reliable end-to-end journeys. All unit economics, funnel percentages and metric targets are my illustrative assumptions, to be validated in a pilot corridor.

Sources

- World Bank (2022), *India's Urban Infrastructure Needs to Cross $840 Billion Over Next 15 Years*: 600M urban residents by 2036.
- Government of India, PIB (2026), *Metro Rail: A Catalyst for Sustainable Urban Growth and Financial Resilience*: 1,095 km operational metro/RRTS across 26 cities in 2025.
- Ola Electric, *Our Business / DRHP*: integrated EV capabilities across software, electronics, motor/drivetrain, cell & battery, manufacturing.
- Ola Electric, *MoveOS*: navigation, live location, connected-vehicle and software capabilities. Ola Electric, *Network Partner*: 1M+ vehicle deliveries.
- URLs: worldbank.org • pib.gov.in • olaelectric.com